

5 Climate change

33

KNOWLEDGE FOCUS

You will answer questions on:

- 5.1 The natural and human causes of climate change
- 5.2 The impacts of climate change at a range of geographic scales
- 5.3 Responses to climate change

EXAM SKILLS FOCUS

In this topic you will:

- show that you understand the command word 'predict' and answer a 'predict' question
- show that you understand the command word 'assess' and answer an 'assess' question
- practise working with mark-scheme awareness.

When you are asked a 'predict' question, you need to suggest what may happen based on available information. This requires looking at patterns in data and using geographical knowledge to make a

reasoned forecast. For example, if a climate graph shows rising temperatures and decreasing rainfall in a region, you might predict that droughts will become more frequent in the future. Your predictions should be realistic and supported by the evidence given.

'Assess' means to make an informed judgement about something. This involves considering different factors and weighing up their importance before reaching a conclusion. For example, if a question asks you to assess the effectiveness of international agreements in reducing climate change, you should examine both their successes and their limitations.

One of the best ways to improve your answers is by using mark schemes to check your own work. Marking your own answers helps you understand what examiners are looking for. Mark schemes can teach you how to properly answer the question, how to use the right geographical terms, how much to write and how to structure your answers clearly. This practice also helps you manage your time better in exams. The more you get used to using mark schemes, the more confident and accurate you will become in your answers.